

CostView — MVP Flow & Layout PRD

How the product delivers on “Fast, Efficient, Secure”

1. Starting point

The founder story defines the promise in three words: **Fast. Efficient. Secure.**

Secure is already solved. The PWA + cloud architecture means project data is never tied to one device, one laptop, one phone. That was the whole point of the story — that’s done at the infrastructure level, not the workflow level.

This document is about the other two: **Fast** and **Efficient**. Not as slogans, but as specific things the MVP does differently from the traditional method (paper files, one laptop, WhatsApp, manual spreadsheet harmonizing) — grounded in what is already built in the current prototype.

Working definitions for this document:

- **Fast** = less typing, less re-entry, less waiting for information that already exists somewhere else in the system.
 - **Efficient** = the right person sees the right thing at the right time, without someone having to chase, compile, or manually route it.
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2. The core mechanic: one flow, not six silos

The traditional method fails because each piece of information lives in its own silo — a requisition on paper, a PO in someone’s email, a delivery note in a site file, an invoice on an accountant’s desk — and someone has to manually walk between all of them to reconcile the numbers.

CostView’s MVP is built around **Operations**, a single connected flow of seven modules that all point back to the same budget and the same audit trail:

Budget → Procurement → Materials → Labour → Progress → Subcontractors → Variations

The Fast/Efficient gain doesn't come from any one module in isolation. It comes from the fact that a number entered once in one module automatically shows up, correctly, everywhere downstream — instead of being retyped by three different people into three different documents.

3. The flow, end to end

1. Budget (*Overview, BOQ, Forecast, Cost Control, Revisions, Final Account*) The BOQ is the anchor. Every cost line downstream — a purchase order, a labour cost, a variation — references a BOQ item, so cost control and forecast update themselves instead of being rebuilt from scratch every reporting cycle. → *Fast*: no manual spreadsheet harmonizing to see where the project stands. → *Efficient*: one true version of the budget everyone works against, instead of five people's personal copies.

2. Procurement (*Requisitions → Supplier Enquiries → Purchase Orders → Deliveries → Invoices → Payments → Supplier Performance*) This is the clearest example of the three-document chain: a **Requisition** becomes a **PO**, the PO is matched against the **GRN** (delivery), and the **Invoice/Payment** is matched against both. Nobody re-types quantities or prices at each stage — they carry forward. → *Fast*: a requisition-to-payment cycle that took phone calls and paper trails now moves through pre-filled, linked documents. → *Efficient*: nothing gets paid that wasn't ordered, and nothing gets ordered that wasn't delivered — the three-way match happens automatically, not by someone manually cross-checking three files.

3. Materials (*Inventory, GRN, Issues, Returns, Transfers, Stock Count*) Site-level stock is tracked against the same GRNs raised in Procurement — a delivery isn't recorded twice. → *Fast*: store staff aren't re-writing what procurement already recorded. → *Efficient*: real-time inventory means no over-ordering or site stock-outs discovered too late.

4. Labour (*Attendance, Payroll, Productivity, Timesheets*) Attendance feeds payroll and productivity automatically instead of a foreman's notebook being manually transcribed at month-end. → *Fast*: payroll doesn't wait on someone re-keying a paper attendance register. → *Efficient*: productivity numbers are a by-product of daily attendance, not a separate report someone has to build.

5. Progress (*Diary, Photos, Inspections, Snags, Safety, Quality*) This is the module that saved the founder story — the site diary that lived on the cloud, not the laptop. Photos, inspections, and snags are logged where they happen and are immediately visible to anyone with access, not bundled into a report days later. → *Fast*: the progress report is a live view, not something compiled overnight before a meeting. → *Efficient*: an inspection finding routes straight into the snag list — it doesn't need a second person to translate a paper note

into a task.

6. Subcontractors (*Contracts, Claims, Certificates, Payments, Performance*)

A subcontractor's claim references their contract terms directly, and payment references the certificate — the same linked-document logic as Procurement, applied to subcontract accounts. → *Fast*: no manually cross-checking a claim against a contract stored somewhere else. → *Efficient*: certified-but-unpaid and claimed-but-uncertified amounts are visible at a glance.

7. Variations (*Register, Approval Workflow, Cost Impact, Instructions*) A variation's cost impact is calculated against the live budget automatically, and the threshold-based approval workflow routes it to the right approver without anyone having to know who to send it to. → *Fast*: cost impact is instant, not a re-calculation exercise. → *Efficient*: approval routing is automatic — the system knows who signs off based on value, not a phone call to find out.

4. What makes the whole thing fast (cross-cutting)

- **Document linking, not document re-entry** — Requisition → PO → GRN → Invoice → Payment is one continuous record, not five separate files someone has to reconcile by hand.
- **Live dashboards instead of compiled reports** — budget position, procurement funnel, top suppliers, and attention-needed items are always current, not assembled the night before a meeting.
- **One place to look** — no switching between paper diary, WhatsApp, Excel, and email to reconstruct what happened on site this week.

5. What makes the whole thing efficient (cross-cutting)

- **Threshold-based approvals** — variations and payments route automatically to the correct approver based on value, removing the “who do I send this to” step entirely.
 - **Full audit trail** — every entry is attributable and timestamped, so there's no version-merging chaos from five people's spreadsheet copies.
 - **Role-based views** — each of the six user roles sees only what's relevant to their work, so people aren't wading through modules that aren't theirs to act on.
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6. Before / after, in the founder story's terms

Traditional method	CostView MVP
Progress report compiled by hand before it can be sent	Progress report is a live view, always ready
One laptop holds the only copy	Cloud-based, PWA, accessible from any device
Requisition, PO, delivery note, invoice live in separate places	One linked document chain, entered once
Someone manually decides who approves a variation	Threshold-based routing decides automatically
Budget position rebuilt from scratch each reporting cycle	Budget updates itself as procurement, labour, and variations post against it

7. Scope note

This PRD covers the **Operations** flow only — the seven modules above are the core MVP that every user role touches. The **Commercial (Contractor/Developer toggle)** modules already scaffolded in the prototype (tendering, contracts, feasibility, project finance, etc.) sit on top of this core and are a later layer, not part of the MVP's fast/efficient case — they extend what the platform does, not how the day-to-day flow works.